BY ORDER OF THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

AIR FORCE MISSION DIRECTIVE 43

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AIR FORCE REVIEW BOARDS AGENCY

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This directive outlines the core responsibilities of the Air Force Review Boards Agency (AFRBA), which acts for the Secretary of the Air Force in a broad range of military and civilian personnel actions. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. Route recommended changes and questions to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document has been substantially revised and needs to be completely reviewed. Major changes include revisions to remove references to the Personnel Security Appeal Board (PSAB), which transferred operations to SAF/OC effective October 1, 2026 and the DoD Physical Disability Board of Review (PDBR) which ceased operations effective October 1, 2024. All pending and new cases/ requests for PDBR review are transferred to the individual applicant's respective Board of Correction of Military/Naval Records.

1. Mission. AFRBA acts on behalf of the Secretary of the Air Force, via delegated authority through the Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Manpower & Reserve Affairs) (SAF/MR) in deciding individual, group, and organizational personnel actions before various review boards, as mandated by federal law or regulation. In the case of the Department of Defense (referred to as Department of War (DoW)) Discharge Appeal Review Board and the DoW Civilian/Military Service Review Board, AFRBA acts on behalf of the Secretary of Defense (referred to as Secretary of War). The AFRBA serves as the highest administrative level of review for certain personnel actions. In specified areas ranging from military decorations to service obligations, it is authorized to act on behalf of the Secretary of the Air Force, and in the case of the Air Force Board for Correction of Military Records, its decisions are by federal law (10 U.S.C. § 1552) binding on all officers of the United States except when procured by fraud. At the core of the AFRBA mission is the commitment to ensure fair and impartial treatment, equity, and due process for all matters before the Agency. Transparency and access to information are also prioritized, and to that end, AFRBA maintains a public reading room in accordance with applicable laws and regulations. The AFRBA Portal serves as a central point of access for information about all boards and processes under the AFRBA's purview, streamlining the submission process and ensuring applicants have the information needed to navigate the review process.

1.1. The Secretary of the Air Force serves as the lead agent for the Department of War Discharge Appeal Review Board (DARB) and exercise authority under Section 1553a of Title 10 U.S.C. on behalf of the Secretary of War.

2. Organizational and Command Structure. The AFRBA is a field operating agency (FOA) that reports directly to SAF/MR. The AFRBA FOA operates eight boards and one Review Office, in addition to the operations of the DoW Electronic Reading Room. These boards/office are as follows: Air Force Board for Correction of Military Records (AFBCMR), Air Force Discharge Review Board (AFDRB), Air Force Personnel Board (AFPB), Air Force Clemency and Parole Board (AFCPB), DoW Civilian and Military Service Review Board (C/MSRB), Department of War Discharge Appeal Review Board (DARB), Secretary of the Air Force Decorations Board (SAFDB), Secretary of the Air Force Remissions Board (SAFRB), and Air Force Civilian Appellate Review Office (AFCARO).

3. Responsibilities. AFRBA:

3.1. Through its component boards and delegated authority, is responsible for adjudicating a wide array of individual and collective cases related to military and civilian personnel actions. This includes deciding individual cases concerning officer grade determinations, resignations in lieu of court-martial, requests for lengthy service probation, awards and decorations, and clemency and parole matters.

3.2. Acting through independent civilian panels, the Air Force Board for Correction of Military Records (AFBCMR), decides applications from current or former Air Force and Space Force members to determine if a correction of a military record is necessary to correct an error or remove an injustice. Serving as the highest administrative level of appeal within the Department of the Air Force, the AFBCMR ensures that applicants exhaust all other available avenues of administrative relief before seeking relief from the AFBCMR.

3.3. Through the Air Force Discharge Review Board (AFDRB), adjudicates applications from former Air Force and Space Force members seeking an upgrade of their discharge characterization.

3.4. Through the Air Force Personnel Board (AFPB), reviews and acts upon a diverse range of military personnel matters requiring Secretarial level review. These cases typically encompass legal and adverse actions, medical and disability appeals, and individual voluntary applications or personnel-related cases.

3.5. Through the Air Force Clemency and Parole Board (AFCPB), reviews case files and when applicable, personal appearances of victims and inmates' representatives, of eligible Airmen and Guardian inmates, to render decisions on clemency, transfer to the Federal Bureau of Prisons (FBOP), community supervision (parole, mandatory supervised release, and revocation of community supervision), restoration, and return-to-duty on behalf of the Secretary of the Air Force.

3.6. As the lead agency for the DoW Civilian/Military Service Review Board (C/MSRB), independently adjudicates applications from groups of civilian employees or contractors to determine whether the group provided service to the United States Armed Forces in a manner considered equivalent to military service for Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) benefits and makes recommendations to SAF/MR for final decisions.

3.7. As the lead agency for the DoW Discharge Appeal Review Board (DARB), independently adjudicates appeals to the Board and when appropriate makes recommendations to upgrade the characterization of a discharge or dismissal to each Secretary of the Military Departments as appropriate.

3.8. Reviews requests from eligible members to engage in foreign government employment (FGE) and makes recommendations to SAF/MR on whether SAF/MR should approve the requests. [Note that FGE requests require approval by SAF/MR and the State Department].

3.9. Through the Secretary of the Air Force Decorations Board (SAFDB), evaluates and renders decisions (approve, disapprove, downgrade or upgrade) on awards requiring approval, by the Secretary of the Air Force, except for the Medal of Honor (MoH), Air Force Cross (AFC), Purple Heart (PH) and Presidential Unit Citation (PUC), and provides recommendations to the Secretary of the Air Force on nominations for the MoH, AFC, PUC, and other awards as required.

3.10. Through the Secretary of the Air Force Remissions Board (SAFRB), renders final decisions on behalf of the Secretary of the Air Force regarding applications for remission of Air Force indebtedness (such as overpayments or erroneous payments) incurred while serving as a member of the Air Force or the Space Force, whether as a regular or a reserve in active status.

3.11. Through the Air Force Civilian Appellate Review Office (AFCARO), makes final agency decisions on behalf of the Secretary of the Air Force on complaints arising under the Equal Employment Opportunity process by civilian employees and applicants for civilian employment, and under the Air Force Military Equal Opportunity program for uniformed members.

3.12. Serves as the lead agency for the DoW Electronic Reading Room for the Military Departments' Boards for Correction of Military/Naval Records (BCM/NR) and the Discharge Review Boards (DRB) in addition to the DoW Discharge Appeal Review Board. In this capacity, it ensures that the decisional documents from October 1998 to the present for each of the aforementioned Boards is available for public research.

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